The 44 Sounds

Note that the 44 sounds (phonemes) have multiple spellings (graphemes) and only the most common ones have been provided in this summary.

20 Vowel Sounds

6 Short Vowels

a	e	i	o	u	oo u
cat	leg	sit	top	rub	book put

5 Long Vowels

ai ay	ee ea	ie igh	oe ow	oo ue
paid tray	bee beat	pie high	toe flow	moon cue

3 R-Controlled Vowels

ar	er ir ur	or
car	her bird hurt	cork

5 Other Vowels

ow ou	oy oi	eer ear	air ere	our
cow out	boy void	deer near	hair there	tour

1 Unstressed Vowel

SCHWA
trumpet across suppose

24 Consonant Sounds

PLACE → *Where in the mouth* MANNER *How the sound is made* ☐	**Bilabial** *with both lips*		**Labio-dental** *with lips and teeth*		**Inter-dental** between teeth		**Alveolar** *front of mouth*		**Post-alveolar** *front of mouth*		**Palatal** *top of mouth*	**Velar** *back of mouth*		**Glottal** *voice box*
Stops *air stopped*	p pet	b bet					t tip	d dip				k c cap	g gap	
Nasal *through nose*		m met						n net					ng sing	
Fricative *high pressure air*			f fan	v van	th thin	th this	s sue	z zoo	sh ship	ge “zh” beige				h hat
Affricates *stop + fricative*							ch chain	j Jane						
Approximants *partial closure of airstream*		w wet						r rat			y yak			
Lateral *air around side of tongue*								l leg						

***Additional consonant* sounds :** *k* + *s* = x (box) *k* + *w* = qu (quit)

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